

L'ma'an Achai

13b

Version 1

Aviezer Wolfson
Arr. Stuart Izon

In rabbinic tradition, L'ma'an Achai V're'ai became associated with the conclusion of Torah study, and it is recited today at the end of Bameh Madlikin on Friday night and Pitum HaK'toret on Shabbat morning. The text is drawn from Psalm 122, where King David expresses his love for Jerusalem. Removed from its original context, the object of the psalmist's prayers, "I will speak peace concerning you" and "I will seek your good" is no longer explicit. The preceding verse, however, makes clear that these words are addressed to Jerusalem: "Pray for the peace of Jerusalem."

This melody was composed by Rabbi Aviezer Wolfson, a noted Torah scholar best known for the widely sung Ma Ashiv. The setting was first recorded by the London School of Jewish Song under Yigal Calek in 1976.

Andante

Chazzan

L'-ma-an a - chai a-chai v'-rei - ai a - da - b'-ra

Ah l'-ma-an a - chai v'-rei - ai

Melody Alto

Ah l'-ma-an a - chai v'-rei ai

Ah l'-ma-an a - chai v'-rei ai

Tenor Bass

Ah l' - ma - an a - chai v'-rei - ai

6 1.

C.

na a - da - b'-ra - na sha - lom l' - ma - an a -

M A

a - da - b'-ra - na sha - lom bach

sha - lom bach

T B

The musical score is written in 6/8 time and marked 'Andante'. It features three vocal parts: Chazzan (Soprano), Melody Alto (Alto), and Tenor Bass (Bass). The Chazzan part begins with a melodic phrase in the first system, followed by the lyrics 'L'-ma-an a - chai a-chai v'-rei - ai a - da - b'-ra'. The Melody Alto part enters in the second system with the lyrics 'Ah l'-ma-an a - chai v'-rei ai'. The Tenor Bass part enters in the third system with the lyrics 'Ah l' - ma - an a - chai v'-rei - ai'. The second system of the score introduces a new section with a first ending bracket. The Chazzan part continues with 'na a - da - b'-ra - na sha - lom l' - ma - an a -'. The Melody Alto part continues with 'a - da - b'-ra - na sha - lom bach'. The Tenor Bass part continues with 'sha - lom bach'. The score concludes with a double bar line.

10 2.

C. 8 na a - da - b'-ra - na sha - lom bach l' - ma - an

M
A 8 a - da - b'-ra - na sha - lom bach

T
B

14

C. 8 beit a-do-nai e - lo - hei - nu a - vak - sha

M
A 8 Ah l' - ma - an beit a-do-nai e - lo - hei - nu

T
B

18 1.

C. 8 tov a - vak - sha tov tov lach l' - ma - an

M
A 8 tov a - vak - sha tov tov lach tov lach

T
B

22 *rit.*
2.

C. 8 tov a - vak - sha tov tov lach

M 8 tov a - vak - sha tov tov lach

A 8 tov a - vak - sha tov tov lach

T 8 tov a - vak - sha tov tov lach

B 8 tov a - vak - sha tov tov lach